WHO REALLY RUNS AUSTRALIA? The Hunt for the Kingmaker

Production Script v2: real footage first, animation as a layer

Runtime: about 13–14 minutes (about 1,950 spoken words). Timestamps are approximate; set final ones from the voiceover. **Narration:** unchanged from v1. The clean Grok file (kingmaker_voiceover_script.md) still matches this script line for line.

HOW THIS SCRIPT IS BUILT

Every shot has two layers.

BASE (real): always real footage or a real photo. This is what gives the film credibility. In priority order:

1. **[PARL]** Official Parliament of Australia footage from ParlView (real events, real people, free under Parliament's conditions).
2. **[ARCHIVE PHOTO]** Real historical photos: National Archives of Australia (NAA), Wikimedia Commons, Flickr (free licences only), US presidential libraries (public domain).
3. **[B-ROLL]** Real location and atmosphere footage from Pexels, Pixabay, Coverr, Mixkit (free for monetised use).
4. **[DOC]** Real documents and data pages: AEC, Hansard, PM Transcripts (CC BY 4.0).

OVERLAY (animation): only when the narration explains something (numbers, systems, timelines, maps). It sits on top of the base layer.

Layering rules for the editor / Claude Code

- **Explain mode:** when an overlay starts, the base layer blurs (Gaussian about 14 px), darkens by about 30% and keeps moving underneath. The overlay animates in on top, timed to the words. When the explanation ends, the overlay leaves and the base snaps back to sharp.
- **Witness mode:** when narration describes a real event or person, show the real footage

or photo full-screen and sharp, with only a small lower-third label.

- **ParlView exception (important):** Parliament's conditions say footage must not be digitally manipulated. So never blur, recolour, speed-ramp or crop ParlView footage to change what it shows. If you need explain mode during a ParlView moment, cut to B-roll for the blurred bed instead. Labels go in a bar below or beside the clip, not burned into the people.
- **Photos never sit still:** every still gets a slow push, pan or parallax (2-layer) move.
- **Pace:** a new base shot every 3–5 seconds. Never more than 6 seconds on one base asset.
- **Credit tag:** every real asset gets a small corner credit, e.g. "Parliament of Australia / ParlView", "NAA", "Wikimedia Commons / CC BY-SA 4.0 / [author]".

Recurring visual identity

Gold crown motif · case board with six SUSPECT cards and red string · navy, parchment and gold palette (teal only in Chapter 6) · Playfair Display for titles, Inter for data (both free on Google Fonts).

COLD OPEN (0:00 – 1:20)

0.1

- VO: (calm, mysterious) On the eleventh of November, 1975, the Prime Minister of Australia went to a meeting at Government House.
- BASE: [ARCHIVE PHOTO] Gough Whitlam, 1975, slow push-in. Then [B-ROLL] dark tree-lined driveway at dusk, slow drive-in.
- SOURCE: NAA PhotoSearch "Whitlam 1975" (Commonwealth photos from 1975 or earlier are now out of copyright). B-roll: Pexels "driveway night car".
- TEXT: 11 NOVEMBER 1975 · GOVERNMENT HOUSE, CANBERRA
- SOUND: Low drone, clock ticking.

0.2

- VO: (slow, heavy) He walked out no longer Prime Minister.
- BASE: [ARCHIVE PHOTO] Whitlam photo, held.

- OVERLAY: [ANIM] A fine crack runs through the photo; one half drifts away into darkness.
- SOUND: Single low hit, then 1 second of silence.

0.3

- VO: (building tension) He hadn't lost an election. He hadn't lost a vote in his own party. He was dismissed by a man the Australian people never voted for.
- BASE: [B-ROLL] Empty ballot box (2 sec) → [ARCHIVE PHOTO] Sir John Kerr, Governor-General, slow pan up from medals to face.
- SOURCE: Pexels "ballot box"; NAA PhotoSearch "Kerr Governor-General"; Wikimedia Commons "John Kerr (governor-general)".
- TEXT: SIR JOHN KERR · GOVERNOR-GENERAL

0.4

- VO: (quick, punchy) Between 2010 and 2018, four sitting prime ministers were pushed out. Not by voters. By their own colleagues.
- BASE: [PARL] Four 1-second flashes: Rudd, Gillard, Abbott and Turnbull each speaking at the dispatch box in their final weeks as PM.
- SOURCE: ParlView, House of Representatives Question Time: June 2010, June 2013, September 2015, August 2018.
- OVERLAY: none on the clips. After the fourth clip, a clean [ANIM] card shows four portrait frames turning grey with years 2010 · 2013 · 2015 · 2018.
- SOUND: Four camera-shutter hits.

0.5

- VO: (intrigued) In 2013, a man was elected to the Senate when his party won about half of one percent of the vote.
- BASE: [PARL] Wide shot of the Senate chamber in session, 2014. → blur to explain mode.
- OVERLAY: [ANIM] Bar chart; a tiny bar labelled 0.5% rockets past all the others. (Because this is ParlView, cut to B-roll "Senate chamber" from Pexels or a blurred Parliament House exterior for the bed instead of blurring the ParlView clip.)
- TEXT: 0.5%

0.6

- VO: (low, ominous) And for decades, the most feared figure in Australian politics wasn't even an Australian citizen.
- BASE: [B-ROLL] Newspaper printing press, extreme close-up, papers racing → stacked newspapers being bundled.
- SOURCE: Pexels / Pixabay "printing press newspaper", "newspaper bundles".
- SOUND: Press machinery rising.

0.7

- VO: (curious, direct to viewer) So who really decides who runs this country? Media barons? Billionaires? Backroom factions?
- BASE: [B-ROLL] Three fast cuts, one per word: newsroom screens → mining haul truck → dark corridor. Then drone shot of Parliament House at dusk.
- SOURCE: Pexels "newsroom", "mining truck", "office corridor night", "Parliament House Canberra aerial".
- OVERLAY: [ANIM] On the drone shot, the gold crown lowers slowly over the building (base stays sharp; crown is a light overlay).

0.8

- VO: (energised, promise) Today, we line up the suspects one by one. And stay to the end, because the real kingmaker is someone almost nobody talks about.
- BASE: [B-ROLL] Slow push along the front of Parliament House → blur.
- OVERLAY: [ANIM] Case board appears with six empty frames: SUSPECT #1 to #6.
- SOUND: Investigative pulse music begins.

0.9 TITLE

- BASE: [B-ROLL] Australian flag on Parliament House flagpole, slow motion, blurred.
- OVERLAY: [ANIM] "WHO REALLY RUNS AUSTRALIA?" with gold underline and crown icon.
- SOURCE: Pexels "Parliament House flag Canberra".

SUSPECT #1: THE PRESS BARON (1:20 – 4:15)

1.1

- VO: (storytelling) Ask most Australians who the kingmaker is, and you'll hear one name first. Rupert Murdoch.
- BASE: [B-ROLL] Newsstand / newsagent racks → [ARCHIVE PHOTO] Rupert Murdoch, full-screen.
- SOURCE: Pexels "newsagent newspapers"; Wikimedia Commons category "Rupert Murdoch" (CC BY or CC BY-SA only; skip NC files). Also check the Ronald Reagan Presidential Library for photos of Murdoch with Reagan in the 1980s: White House photos are US government works and public domain.
- OVERLAY: Small "SUSPECT #1 · THE PRESS BARON" tag slides in at the bottom.

1.2

- VO: (narrative) He inherited a single newspaper in Adelaide in the 1950s and turned it into a global empire. Newspapers, television, and eventually Fox News in America.
- BASE: [B-ROLL] Adelaide city aerial → London skyline → New York Midtown at night.
- SOURCE: Pexels "Adelaide aerial", "London skyline", "Manhattan night".
- OVERLAY: [ANIM] Thin gold line traces Adelaide → Sydney → London → New York on a translucent world map (base blurred).

1.3

- VO: (matter-of-fact) In Australia, his company became the country's largest media organisation, with papers in nearly every major city.
- BASE: [B-ROLL] Quick cuts of Sydney, Melbourne, Brisbane, Perth skylines.
- OVERLAY: [ANIM] Map of Australia; capitals light up with a newspaper icon (base blurred).
- TEXT: Source tag: Reuters / Al Jazeera, 2020

1.4

- VO: (reveal, slight smile) And here's the first twist. In 1985, Murdoch became an American citizen, because US law didn't allow foreigners to own American TV stations. So for decades, the most feared player in Australian politics wasn't technically Australian.
- BASE: [B-ROLL] US flag waving → TV broadcast control room → [ARCHIVE PHOTO] Murdoch.

- SOURCE: Pexels “American flag”, “broadcast control room”.
- OVERLAY: [ANIM] Passport flips from Australian to American over the control room shot (blurred). Case board: first red string pinned.
- TEXT: 1985 · US CITIZENSHIP

1.5

- VO: (warm, nostalgic) His power first showed in 1972. His national paper, The Australian, backed Labor’s Gough Whitlam and the famous “It’s Time” campaign. Whitlam won.
- BASE: [ARCHIVE PHOTO] Whitlam campaigning in 1972 → Whitlam being sworn in, December 1972.
- SOURCE: NAA PhotoSearch “Whitlam 1972”, “Whitlam swearing in 1972”; Wikimedia Commons “1972 Australian federal election”.
- TEXT: 1972 · “IT’S TIME”

1.6

- VO: (darker) Three years later, Murdoch turned. During the 1975 election, his papers campaigned so hard against Whitlam that seventy-five of his own journalists wrote to him in protest.
- BASE: [ARCHIVE PHOTO] Malcolm Fraser campaigning, 1975 → [B-ROLL] close-up of an old typewriter typing, then a hand signing paper.
- SOURCE: NAA PhotoSearch “Fraser 1975 campaign”; Pexels “vintage typewriter”, “signing letter”.
- OVERLAY: [ANIM] Over the signing shot (blurred), a parchment letter appears; 75 signature marks fill the bottom one by one. Recreated, not an invented text: label reads “Letter from 75 News Limited journalists, Dec 1975”.

1.7

- VO: (dramatic) And on the eighth of December 1975, they did something no Australian journalists had done before. They went on strike over their own paper’s coverage.
- BASE: [B-ROLL] Empty newsroom desks, chair still spinning → printing press slowing to a stop.
- SOURCE: Pexels “empty office desks”, “printing press stop”.
- OVERLAY: Lower-third only.
- TEXT: 8 DECEMBER 1975 · FIRST STRIKE OVER EDITORIAL COVERAGE

- SOUND: Typewriters stopping one by one.

1.8

- VO: (fair, even) Murdoch had a different view. He later argued it was the journalists who were showing bias, and that his editors were simply cutting it out.
- BASE: [ARCHIVE PHOTO] Murdoch, neutral expression, slow push.
- TEXT: Murdoch's position · 1977 interview

1.9

- VO: (building) Ever since, prime ministers have known one thing: you don't want the Murdoch papers against you.
- BASE: [B-ROLL] Morning newspaper landing on a doorstep → [PARL] a Prime Minister at the dispatch box (any, neutral).
- SOURCE: Pexels "newspaper doorstep"; ParlView Question Time.

1.10

- VO: (serious) In 2020, former Prime Minister Kevin Rudd called Murdoch's empire a cancer on Australian democracy, and launched a petition for a royal commission.
- BASE: [ARCHIVE PHOTO] Kevin Rudd → [B-ROLL] hands typing on a laptop, a "sign petition" style form (generic, no real website).
- SOURCE: Wikimedia Commons "Kevin Rudd"; Pexels "typing laptop".
- OVERLAY: [ANIM] Signature counter ticking up over the blurred laptop shot.

1.11

- VO: (impressed) It got five hundred and one thousand, eight hundred and seventy-six signatures. The biggest electronic petition in the history of Australia's Parliament.
- BASE: [PARL] Labor MP Andrew Leigh carrying the printed petition into the House of Representatives. Full-screen, unaltered.
- SOURCE: ParlView, House of Representatives, 9 November 2020.
- TEXT (in lower bar): 501,876 SIGNATURES · Source: Parliament of Australia

1.12

- VO: (careful, balanced) Former Liberal Prime Minister Malcolm Turnbull backed the petition, and has argued the Murdoch press helped bring him down in 2018. News Corp has always rejected claims like these.

- BASE: [PARL] Rudd and Turnbull giving evidence to the Senate media diversity inquiry, 2021 → [PARL] News Corp executives giving evidence to the same inquiry (for balance).
- SOURCE: ParlView, Senate Environment and Communications References Committee, media diversity inquiry, February 2021 (find the exact hearing days in the committee's Hansard on ParlInfo).
- TEXT: "News Corp denies these claims"

1.13

- VO: (record scratch energy) So, case closed? Not so fast.
- BASE: [B-ROLL] Polling day crowd outside a school → freeze frame.
- OVERLAY: [ANIM] Gold stamp "CASE OPEN" slams onto the frozen frame.
- SOUND: Record scratch.

1.14

- VO: (analytical) In 2022, and again in 2025, Labor won federal elections despite heavy criticism from parts of the Murdoch press. In 2025, the Opposition Leader even lost his own seat.
- BASE: [PARL] Anthony Albanese at the dispatch box, 2022 → [PARL] opening of the 48th Parliament, July 2025 (wide chamber).
- SOURCE: ParlView, House of Representatives, July 2022 and July 2025.
- OVERLAY: [ANIM] After the clips, result cards over blurred Parliament House B-roll: 2022 Labor win · 2025 Labor win · "Opposition Leader loses Dickson". Data: AEC Tally Room.

1.15

- VO: (reflective) Murdoch is now in his nineties. He stepped down as chairman in 2023. And in 2025, a bitter family battle ended with his son Lachlan in control of the empire until 2050.
- BASE: [ARCHIVE PHOTO] Rupert Murdoch, later years → [ARCHIVE PHOTO] Lachlan Murdoch.
- SOURCE: Wikimedia Commons "Rupert Murdoch", "Lachlan Murdoch" (free licences only).
- OVERLAY: [ANIM] Simple family-tree branches; Lachlan's lights gold; "2050" stamp (on blurred photo bed).

- TEXT: Source: News Corp / Fox Corp announcement, Sept 2025

1.16

- VO: (open question) The press baron was once a kingmaker. The real question is whether newspapers still have that power, when so many young Australians now get their news from their phones.
- BASE: [B-ROLL] Young commuter scrolling a phone on a train → newspaper left on an empty seat.
- SOURCE: Pexels “scrolling phone train”, “newspaper on seat”.

SUSPECT #2: THE MAN WHO OWNED THE SCREEN (4:15 – 5:35)

2.1

- VO: (smooth) If Murdoch owned the morning paper, another man owned the evening.
- BASE: [B-ROLL] Old CRT television switching on, static → living room at night lit by a TV.
- SOURCE: Pixabay “old television static”, Pexels “watching tv night”.
- OVERLAY: “SUSPECT #2 · THE TV TYCOON” tag.

2.2

- VO: (admiring, colourful) Kerry Packer. Owner of Channel Nine. The man who turned cricket upside down with World Series Cricket, and for years one of the richest people in Australia.
- BASE: [ARCHIVE PHOTO] Kerry Packer → [B-ROLL] cricket ground under floodlights at night → cricket ball close-up.
- SOURCE: Wikimedia Commons “Kerry Packer” (check carefully: some Packer photos on Wikipedia are fair-use only and not on Commons; use only free Commons files). Pexels “cricket stadium night lights”.
- FALLBACK: if no free Packer photo exists, use a typographic name card over the cricket B-roll.

2.3

- VO: (knowing) Packer didn’t need to write editorials. He had something better. Access.

- BASE: [B-ROLL] Vintage phone ringing on a desk → a hand picking it up.
- SOURCE: Pexels “vintage telephone ringing”.

2.4

- VO: (building to a moment) In 1991, a parliamentary committee on the print media called him in to answer questions about media ownership and his business affairs.
- BASE: [PARL] Packer giving evidence to the House of Representatives Select Committee on the Print Media, 1991.
- SOURCE: ParlView (archive covers 1991). Find the hearing date in the committee transcript on ParlInfo, then search ParlView by that date.
- FALLBACK: [B-ROLL] committee room in Parliament House / formal hearing room + [DOC] the committee’s 1992 report cover “News and fair facts” from aph.gov.au.

2.5

- VO: (amused) He didn’t flinch. He told the MPs, in effect, that anyone who didn’t minimise their tax within the law needed their head read, and that the government wasn’t exactly spending its money wisely anyway.
- BASE: [PARL] Continue the hearing footage, unaltered. If unavailable: [B-ROLL] tax forms and calculator close-up.
- OVERLAY: Only if using B-roll: [ANIM] paraphrase card, no quotation marks.
- SOUND: Room tone, one gavel tap.

2.6

- VO: (reflective) Politicians from both sides would recall that moment for years. A billionaire lecturing Parliament, and Parliament mostly sitting there and taking it.
- BASE: [B-ROLL] Parliament House exterior, slow tilt up the flagpole.

2.7

- VO: (soft close) Packer died in 2005. His story shows something important. A kingmaker doesn’t always choose the king. Sometimes he just makes sure every king knows who’s in the room.
- BASE: [B-ROLL] Empty boardroom chair, slow push → blur.
- OVERLAY: [ANIM] Case board: Packer card pinned, red string to Murdoch’s card.

SUSPECT #3: THE MINING MONEY (5:35 – 8:20)

3.1

- VO: (awe) Australia digs things up and sells them to the world. Iron ore. Coal. Gas.
- BASE: [B-ROLL] Three hard cuts on each word: red iron ore pit aerial → coal train → LNG plant flare or gas pipeline.
- SOURCE: Pexels / Pixabay “open pit mine aerial”, “coal train”, “gas plant”. Avoid visible company logos.
- OVERLAY: “SUSPECT #3 · THE MINING MONEY” tag.

3.2

- VO: (tense) In May 2010, Kevin Rudd’s government announced a new tax on mining super profits.
- BASE: [PARL] Treasurer or PM speaking in the House on the resource tax, May 2010 → [DOC] PM Transcripts page for the May 2010 tax announcement (CC BY 4.0).
- SOURCE: ParlView, House of Representatives, May 2010; pmtranscripts.pmc.gov.au, search “resource super profits tax”.
- TEXT: MAY 2010 · RESOURCE SUPER PROFITS TAX

3.3

- VO: (fast, intense) The industry hit back with one of the biggest campaigns ever run against a single government policy. In about six weeks, mining interests spent around twenty-two million dollars.
- BASE: [B-ROLL] Haul trucks rolling in slow motion → TV screens showing static ads (generic) → blur.
- OVERLAY: [ANIM] Stacked bars: Minerals Council of Australia $17.2m, BHP Billiton $4.2m, others.
- TEXT: $22 MILLION · ABOUT 6 WEEKS · Source: AEC disclosures, reported by SMH 2011

3.4

- VO: (vivid) In Perth, thousands rallied against the tax. On the back of a truck stood one of the richest people in the country, Gina Rinehart. Beside her, fellow billionaire Andrew Forrest.
- BASE: [ARCHIVE PHOTO] 2010 Perth anti-mining-tax rally if a free-licence photo exists

(search Wikimedia Commons and Flickr with “commercial use allowed” filter: “mining tax rally Perth 2010”) → [B-ROLL] Perth CBD aerial → [ARCHIVE PHOTO] Gina Rinehart → [ARCHIVE PHOTO] Andrew Forrest.

- SOURCE: Commons “Gina Rinehart”, “Andrew Forrest”.
- FALLBACK: if no free rally photo exists, use Perth CBD B-roll + generic crowd B-roll (Pexels “protest crowd placards”, no readable unrelated slogans) with a lower-third “Perth, June 2010”. Name cards for anyone without a free photo.

3.5

- VO: (slow, weighty) On the twenty-fourth of June 2010, about seven weeks after the tax was announced, Kevin Rudd was no longer Prime Minister.
- BASE: [PARL] House of Representatives, 24 June 2010: Julia Gillard’s first Question Time as Prime Minister.
- SOURCE: ParlView, 24 June 2010.
- TEXT: 24 JUNE 2010

3.6

- VO: (careful, fair) Now, to be fair, Rudd fell for many reasons. Falling polls. A shelved climate policy. Colleagues who found him hard to work with. The mining campaign didn’t remove him on its own. But it showed what happens when big money and a government collide.
- BASE: [B-ROLL] Parliament House at night, lights in windows → blur.
- OVERLAY: [ANIM] Four cause cards appear one by one as each is spoken: polls · climate policy · internal tensions · mining campaign. No percentages.

3.7

- VO: (wry) His successor, Julia Gillard, quickly negotiated a much weaker tax with the biggest miners. It raised far less than expected, and it was scrapped in 2014.
- BASE: [ARCHIVE PHOTO] Julia Gillard → [PARL] Senate vote on the repeal of the mining tax, September 2014.
- SOURCE: Commons “Julia Gillard”; ParlView, Senate, September 2014.
- TEXT: MRRT · INTRODUCED 2012 · REPEALED 2014

3.8

- VO: (playful, then sharp) And then there’s Clive Palmer. Mining billionaire. Dinosaur park

owner. And the biggest political spender Australia has ever seen.

- BASE: [ARCHIVE PHOTO] Clive Palmer → [PARL] Palmer speaking in the House as an MP, 2013–2016.
- SOURCE: Commons “Clive Palmer”; ParlView, House of Representatives (Palmer was Member for Fairfax 2013–2016).

3.9

- VO: (data-driven, building) In 2019, his United Australia Party declared about eighty-nine million dollars in spending. Seats won: zero. In 2022, about one hundred and twenty-three million. Seats won: one, in the Senate. In 2025, his new party, Trumpet of Patriots, spent about fifty-three million. Seats won: zero.
- BASE: [B-ROLL] Roadside billboards along a highway → mailbox stuffed with flyers → phone buzzing with a text (generic) → blur.
- SOURCE: Pexels “highway billboards”, “mailbox flyers”, “phone notification”.
- OVERLAY: [ANIM] Gold spending bars rise for 2019 / 2022 / 2025; tiny chair icons below: 0 · 1 · 0.
- TEXT: Source: Grattan Institute analysis of AEC returns

3.10

- VO: (punchline) Meanwhile, One Nation spent about three million dollars in 2025 and won three Senate seats.
- BASE: [PARL] Senate chamber, July 2025 (new senators sworn in).
- OVERLAY: After the clip, the bar chart returns over blurred Parliament House B-roll with a tiny One Nation bar and three chairs.
- TEXT: Source: AEC data, reported by AAP / The New Daily

3.11

- VO: (verdict) Palmer has argued his ads helped stop Labor in 2019. Maybe they did. But if money alone could buy power, Clive Palmer would be Prime Minister by now.
- BASE: [ARCHIVE PHOTO] Palmer → [B-ROLL] money counting machine, slowing → blur.
- OVERLAY: [ANIM] Case board: crown hovers over the mining card, wobbles, drifts away.

SUSPECT #4: THE FACELESS MEN (8:20 – 10:20)

4.1

- VO: (hushed, conspiratorial) Remember the four prime ministers from the start? Taken down in eight years. Not by voters. By their own side.
- BASE: [B-ROLL] Long corridor at night, slow dolly → office door closing.
- SOURCE: Pexels “dark corridor night”, “office door closing”.
- OVERLAY: “SUSPECT #4 · THE FACELESS MEN” tag.

4.2

- VO: (explainer, clear) Here’s how. In Australia, you don’t directly elect the Prime Minister. You vote for your local MP. The party with the most seats forms government, and the party room picks its leader. Which means the leader can be replaced by a vote of their own colleagues, at any time.
- BASE: [B-ROLL] Voter at a polling booth → Parliament House exterior → meeting room table → blur (bed changes with each step of the explanation).
- OVERLAY: [ANIM] Explainer chain: voter → local MP → party room → leader’s chair; a hand swaps the leader figure.

4.3

- VO: (dramatic) When Rudd was toppled in 2010, a small group of powerful factional organisers was credited with gathering the numbers overnight. The press gave them a name that stuck. The faceless men.
- BASE: [B-ROLL] Phone screen glowing in a dark room → Canberra at night time-lapse.
- SOURCE: Pexels “phone dark room”, “Canberra night time-lapse”.
- OVERLAY: [ANIM] Light layer: faceless silhouettes fade in around the phone shot.
- TEXT: “THE FACELESS MEN”

4.4

- VO: (explainer) Factions are the hidden machinery inside both major parties. They help decide who gets picked to run in safe seats. Which means they often decide who becomes an MP before a single vote is cast.
- BASE: [B-ROLL] Hands moving chess pieces, close-up → blur.

- SOURCE: Pexels “chess hands close up”.
- OVERLAY: [ANIM] Map with a few “safe seat” outlines; a ticket labelled PRESELECTION drops into each.

4.5

- VO: (energetic) And behind Labor’s factions sit the unions. In 2007, the union movement’s “Your Rights at Work” campaign helped sweep John Howard from power. Howard even lost his own seat.
- BASE: [ARCHIVE PHOTO] “Your Rights at Work” rally, 2005–2007 (search Flickr “Your Rights at Work rally” with commercial-use filter, and Wikimedia Commons) → [ARCHIVE PHOTO] John Howard → [B-ROLL] Sydney suburbs aerial (Bennelong area: Ryde, Epping).
- SOURCE: Commons “John Howard”.
- FALLBACK: [PARL] Howard at the dispatch box, 2007, then Sydney suburbs.
- OVERLAY: [ANIM] Bennelong outline flips colour on the blurred suburbs shot.
- TEXT: 2007 · PM LOSES HIS OWN SEAT

4.6

- VO: (tense montage) Rudd in 2010. Gillard in 2013. Abbott in 2015. Turnbull in 2018.
- BASE: [PARL] Four clips, one per name, each the leader at the dispatch box in their final weeks.
- SOURCE: ParlView, same dates as Shot 0.4 (use different moments so it doesn’t repeat).
- SOUND: Heartbeat rhythm.

4.7

- VO: (reflective) After all that chaos, both major parties changed their rules to make it much harder to knife a sitting leader.
- BASE: [B-ROLL] Revolving door slowing → door locking / padlock closing.
- SOURCE: Pexels “revolving door”, “padlock close up”.

4.8

- VO: (verdict) So the faceless men really were kingmakers. But they were kingmakers who kept hurting themselves. Every spill made voters angrier, and the revolving door became a national joke.

- BASE: [B-ROLL] Commuters watching news on a screen at a station (no readable network logos) → blur.
- OVERLAY: [ANIM] Case board: crown sits on the factions card, then slides off.

SUSPECT #5: THE PREFERENCE WHISPERER (10:20 – 12:00)

5.1

- VO: (mysterious) Now, our second mystery. How does someone get into the Senate when their party wins about half of one percent of the vote?
- BASE: [ARCHIVE PHOTO] A real 2013 Senate ballot paper, often photographed because of its huge size (search Wikimedia Commons “Senate ballot paper 2013 New South Wales” or “Victoria”).
- FALLBACK: [B-ROLL] Generic voting booth with a large paper.
- OVERLAY: “SUSPECT #5 · THE PREFERENCE WHISPERER” tag.

5.2

- VO: (explainer, clear) Australia uses preferential voting. If your first choice can’t win, your vote flows to your next choice, and so on. For years, Senate voters could tick just one box, and their preferences would flow according to deals the parties had made behind the scenes.
- BASE: [B-ROLL] Vote counting: hands sorting ballot papers in piles → blur.
- SOURCE: Pexels / Pixabay “counting ballots”, “ballot papers”. The AEC also publishes photos of counting; check the licence on aec.gov.au before use.
- OVERLAY: [ANIM] A vote token travels along arrows from box to box.

5.3

- VO: (intrigued) A political strategist named Glenn Druery became famous for organising these deals among dozens of micro-parties. Each tiny party swapped preferences with the others, so the votes snowballed until one of them crossed the line.
- BASE: [ARCHIVE PHOTO] Glenn Druery, if a free photo exists on Commons → [B-ROLL] hands shaking across a table → blur.

- FALLBACK: name card over the handshake B-roll.
- OVERLAY: [ANIM] Web of invented micro-party icons; a snowball rolls through and grows.

5.4

- VO: (reveal) In 2013, Ricky Muir from the Australian Motoring Enthusiast Party was elected to the Senate for Victoria. His party's primary vote? About half of one percent.
- BASE: [PARL] Ricky Muir in the Senate, 2014 (first speech or a debate).
- SOURCE: ParlView, Senate, 2014. Commons "Ricky Muir" for a still.
- OVERLAY: After the clip, the 0.5% bar from the cold open returns over blurred Melbourne B-roll and rockets up.
- TEXT: 2013 · VICTORIA · ABOUT 0.5% PRIMARY VOTE · Source: AEC

5.5

- VO: (balanced) Supporters said the system was working as designed. Critics said voters had no idea where their votes were going.
- BASE: [B-ROLL] Person looking puzzled at a long form → blur.
- OVERLAY: [ANIM] Two equal panels: "SYSTEM WORKING" vs "VOTERS IN THE DARK".

5.6

- VO: (resolution) Parliament sided with the critics. In 2016, it changed the Senate voting rules so voters control their own preferences.
- BASE: [PARL] Senate debate and vote on the Commonwealth Electoral Amendment Bill 2016 (the all-night sitting, March 2016).
- SOURCE: ParlView, Senate, March 2016.
- TEXT: 2016 · GROUP VOTING TICKETS ABOLISHED

5.7

- VO: (verdict) But it proved something. In Australia, the kingmaker isn't always the person with the most votes. Sometimes, it's the person who understands the rules best.
- BASE: [B-ROLL] Close-up of a rulebook / law book pages turning → blur.
- OVERLAY: [ANIM] Case board update.

SUSPECT #6: THE NEW KINGMAKERS (12:00 – 13:20)

6.1

- VO: (surprised) In 2022, something happened the old kingmakers never saw coming.
- BASE: [B-ROLL] Leafy inner-city streets in Sydney's eastern suburbs and Melbourne's Kew/Hawthorn → blur.
- SOURCE: Pexels "Bondi aerial", "Melbourne suburbs aerial".
- OVERLAY: [ANIM] Teal wash spreads over a map of the target seats.

6.2

- VO: (narrative) Independent candidates, many of them professional women campaigning on climate and integrity, won seats the Liberal Party had held for generations. Kooyong. Wentworth. Mackellar. They became known as the teals.
- BASE: [PARL] Three short clips of first speeches in the House: Monique Ryan (Kooyong), Allegra Spender (Wentworth), Sophie Scamps (Mackellar), July–August 2022.
- SOURCE: ParlView, House of Representatives, 2022.
- TEXT (lower bar): seat names as they are spoken.

6.3

- VO: (explainer) Behind many of them was Climate 200, a fundraising group founded by businessman Simon Holmes à Court. It raised money from thousands of donors and shared it among independent candidates.
- BASE: [ARCHIVE PHOTO] Simon Holmes à Court (Commons, free licence only; otherwise name card) → [B-ROLL] campaign volunteers handing out flyers → blur.
- SOURCE: Pexels "volunteers flyers street".
- OVERLAY: [ANIM] Many small coins flow into one pot, then split out to candidate icons.
- ALSO AVAILABLE: [PARL] Climate 200 representatives gave evidence to Parliament's Joint Standing Committee on Electoral Matters in its inquiries after the 2022 election. Search ParlView for JSCEM hearings 2022–2024.

6.4

- VO: (balanced, two-sided) Supporters say Climate 200 gave community candidates a

fair shot against party machines. Critics say it works like a party in all but name, using big money to pick winners while claiming to be independent.

- BASE: [PARL] Two short clips for balance: a teal MP speaking, then a Liberal MP criticising teals/Climate 200 in the House or at JSCEM.
- SOURCE: ParlView, 2022–2024.
- OVERLAY: Text only, in a bar beside the clip.

6.5

- VO: (pattern reveal) And notice the pattern. Every generation, a new force learns to bend the system. Newspapers. Television. Mining money. Factions. Preference deals. Now crowdfunded independents.
- BASE: [B-ROLL + PHOTO] Rapid callback montage, one real shot per word: printing press → old TV → haul truck → dark corridor → ballot paper → volunteers.
- OVERLAY: [ANIM] After the montage, the full case board with all six cards and red string, over blurred Parliament House.

THE RULEBOOK JUST CHANGED (13:20 – 14:20)

7.1

- VO: (urgent, newsy) And right now, the rules of the game are changing again.
- BASE: [DOC] Screen recording scrolling the AEC page “Explaining the changes to political funding and disclosure” (aec.gov.au/FADReform). Government webpage, shown as a real source.

7.2

- VO: (explainer) On the first of July 2026, the biggest changes to Australia’s electoral law in forty years came into force. For the first time, there are national caps on political donations, and on election spending. Political parties can spend up to ninety million dollars nationally. Outside groups, like unions or Climate 200, have a cap of eleven million.
- BASE: [PARL] Parliament passing the Electoral Reform Bill, February 2025 → [B-ROLL] Parliament House exterior → blur.
- OVERLAY: [ANIM] Two gauges: party cap $90M, third-party cap $11M. Palmer’s 2022 bar from Chapter 3 returns and hits the cap line.

- TEXT: 1 JULY 2026 · Source: Australian Electoral Commission

7.3

- VO: (balanced) The government says it's about stopping big money from buying elections. But some independents call it a major-party stitch-up, arguing the caps protect parties that already have huge war chests.
- BASE: [PARL] Two clips with equal time: the minister (Senator Don Farrell) speaking for the bill; an independent speaking against it. Senate or House, February 2025.
- SOURCE: ParlView, February 2025.

7.4

- VO: (open question) Whoever is right, one thing is clear. The next election will be fought under rules no billionaire has ever played by.
- BASE: [B-ROLL] Gavel coming down / law book closing → blur.
- OVERLAY: [ANIM] Case board: a new card "THE RULEBOOK" pins itself in the middle.

THE REVEAL (14:20 – 15:45)

8.1

- VO: (slow, intimate) Here's the thing almost nobody talks about.
- BASE: [B-ROLL] School hall polling place, queue out the door, early morning light.
- SOURCE: Pexels / Pixabay "voting queue", "polling station".
- SOUND: Music drops to solo piano.

8.2

- VO: (explainer) Since 1924, voting in Australian federal elections has been compulsory. Turn up, or pay a fine. That's why around nine in ten enrolled Australians vote. Far more than in countries like the United States or the United Kingdom.
- BASE: [ARCHIVE PHOTO] Early 20th-century Australian polling place (pre-1955 photos are public domain; search NLA Trove and Commons "polling booth 1920s Australia") → [B-ROLL] modern polling queue → blur.
- OVERLAY: [ANIM] Turnout bars: Australia about 90% vs the US and UK.

- TEXT: Source: AEC / International IDEA

8.3

- VO: (thoughtful) Think about what that means. In most democracies, elections are won by firing up your loyal supporters and getting them to show up. In Australia, almost everyone shows up. Including the people who barely follow politics at all.
- BASE: [B-ROLL] Crowd at a rally (generic) → ordinary street crowd crossing at lights in an Australian city.
- SOURCE: Pexels “Sydney pedestrian crossing”, “Melbourne crowd”.

8.4

- VO: (warm) The busy parent who decides on the walk into the polling booth. The voter in a marginal seat who didn’t read the papers, didn’t watch the debate, and has never heard of a preference whisperer.
- BASE: [B-ROLL] Parent with kids walking into a school → tradie getting out of a ute → nurse leaving a hospital at dawn → student on a bus.
- SOURCE: Pexels “parent kids school”, “tradesman ute”, “nurse night shift”, “student bus”.

8.5

- VO: (building) Every kingmaker in this story has spent their power trying to reach that one person. Murdoch’s headlines. Packer’s screens. Palmer’s billboards. The unions’ ads. The teals’ volunteers on every street corner.
- BASE: [B-ROLL] Callback montage on each phrase: newspaper → TV → billboards → rally → volunteers.
- OVERLAY: [ANIM] At the end, the case board cards fly in around a small figure of a voter (on blurred street B-roll).

8.6

- VO: (powerful) And when that person makes up their mind, billionaires lose, newspaper owners lose, and sometimes even the leader of a major party loses their own seat.
- BASE: [ARCHIVE PHOTO] John Howard → [ARCHIVE PHOTO] Peter Dutton (Commons, free licence).
- TEXT: 2007 · LOST OWN SEAT / 2025 · LOST OWN SEAT

8.7

- VO: (callback, gentle) Remember the man from our very first scene? Gough Whitlam was

dismissed by the Governor-General. Whatever you think of that decision, a month later, there was an election.

- BASE: [ARCHIVE PHOTO] The Whitlam photo from Shot 0.1, now whole again → [ARCHIVE PHOTO] 1975 election campaign crowd.
- SOURCE: NAA PhotoSearch “1975 election”.

8.8

- VO: (measured) And the voters delivered their verdict: a landslide win for Malcolm Fraser. The final word didn’t belong to the Governor-General, or to Murdoch, or to anyone in Canberra. It belonged to the ballot box.
- BASE: [ARCHIVE PHOTO] Malcolm Fraser, 1975 → [B-ROLL] ballot paper dropping into a box, slow motion.
- SOURCE: NAA PhotoSearch “Fraser 1975”; Pexels “ballot box vote”.
- TEXT: 13 DECEMBER 1975

8.9

- VO: (slow, final) The kingmakers are real. They shape what you see, what you hear, and who ends up on your ballot. But in Australia, every one of them has to answer to the same person in the end.
- BASE: [B-ROLL] Slow push towards a voter’s hands at a polling booth.
- OVERLAY: [ANIM] The gold crown descends gently into the voter’s open hands (light layer, base stays sharp).

8.10

- VO: (quiet, with weight) The one holding the pencil.
- BASE: [B-ROLL] Extreme close-up: pencil marking a ballot (generic, no real names). Hold, fade to black.
- SOUND: Music resolves. 2 seconds of silence.

OUTRO (15:45 – 16:15)

9.1

- VO: (friendly, direct) So who do you think holds the most power in Australia today? The

media, the money, the parties, or the voters? Tell me in the comments.

- BASE: [B-ROLL] Parliament House at golden hour, blurred.
- OVERLAY: [ANIM] Four-option poll card.

9.2

- VO: (upbeat) And if you want to know how Australia went from a prison colony to one of the world's richest democracies, our full history of Australia is right here.
- BASE: End screen with your Australia history video.

ASSET COUNT

Layer	Approx. count
ParlView clips (real parliamentary footage)	about 25
Real archive photos (NAA, Commons, Flickr, Trove, US libraries)	about 30
Free B-roll clips	about 75
Real documents and data pages	about 5
Animation overlays	about 30 (all on top of real footage)

Every shot except the title card has a real base layer.

SOURCING AND LICENSING GUIDE

1. ParlView (free real footage)

Watch, search and download Senate, House and committee recordings, with archive back to 1991, at aph.gov.au → Watch, Read, Listen → ParlView. You need the date to search. Conditions: fair and accurate reports only, balanced presentation of differing views, no party-political or commercial advertising, and no digital manipulation. Credit "Parliament of Australia / ParlView" on screen.

2. Real photos

- **National Archives of Australia.** Commonwealth copyright lasts 50 years after the year made or first published, so government photos from 1975 and earlier are now public domain in Australia. Confirm the photo was taken by a government photographer (e.g. Australian Information Service), not a newspaper.
- **Trove / National Library of Australia.** Any photo taken before 1955 is out of copyright in Australia. Good for the early polling-place images.
- **Wikimedia Commons.** Use Public Domain, CC0, CC BY or CC BY-SA. Skip NC and ND licences on a monetised channel. Note the author and licence for the credit line.
- **Flickr.** Use the licence filter "Commercial use allowed". Credit the photographer.
- **US presidential libraries.** Photos taken by White House photographers are US government works and public domain (useful for Murdoch with US presidents).
- **Unsplash:** only standard free photos. "Unsplash+" images are paid.

3. Free B-roll

Pexels, Pixabay, Coverr, Mixkit. Avoid clips with clear brand logos or readable real campaign material from other countries.

4. Real documents (CC BY 4.0)

PM Transcripts (pmtranscripts.pmc.gov.au) text is licensed CC BY 4.0, except the Coat of Arms and photos/graphics. Credit: "Source: Licensed from the Commonwealth of Australia under CC BY 4.0". AEC web pages and data for the money and results charts.

5. Never use without a licence

TV network news footage (ABC, Nine, Seven, Ten, Sky), newspaper pages or photos (News Corp, Nine/Fairfax, AAP, Getty), and NFSA footage. If you want the famous 1975 Parliament steps footage, license it from the NFSA or the broadcaster. YouTube Content ID doesn't care about fair dealing arguments.

6. Music and sound

Pixabay Music and YouTube Audio Library. Mood map: investigative pulse (open, Ch. 1), retro synth (Ch. 2), industrial percussion (Ch. 3), dark strings (Ch. 4), playful plucks (Ch. 5),

modern electronic (Ch. 6–7), solo piano into a warm swell (reveal).

FACT SHEET AND SOURCES

Claim in script	Source
75 journalists wrote to Murdoch; strike voted 8 Dec 1975; return to work 10 Dec	Patricia Edgar, "The press and the Dismissal – Part II"; Macquarie University; AustLit
First strike in Australia over editorial coverage	Macquarie University, 2015
Murdoch's 1977 response that journalists were the biased ones	Murdoch on A Current Affair, 1977, quoted by Patricia Edgar
501,876 signatures; largest e-petition; tabled by Andrew Leigh	Al Jazeera / AFP 2020; The New Daily, 9 Nov 2020
Turnbull backed the petition	SBS News 2020
Murdoch settlement, Lachlan control, trust to 2050	News Corp announcement via AdNews, 9 Sep 2025; Axios, 8 Sep 2025
Murdoch stepped down as chairman, 2023	Nieman Lab / WSJ, 21 Sep 2023
$22m mining campaign in six weeks; MCA $17.2m; BHP $4.2m	AEC figures reported by SMH, Feb 2011; The Conversation
Rinehart on the back of a truck, Forrest at Perth rally	Green Left reporting via London Mining Network (confirm with a mainstream 2010 report before publishing)
MRRT introduced 2012	Government statement via Wikipedia (Minerals Resource Rent Tax)
Palmer: $89m (2019), $123m (2022), Trumpet of Patriots $53m (2025)	Grattan Institute, "Election 2025: where the money came from"
One Senate seat in 2022 (Ralph Babet)	InDaily / AAP, Dec 2022
One Nation about $3m, three Senate	The New Daily / AAP, Feb 2026

seats in 2025	
Electoral reforms from 1 July 2026; biggest change in 40 years	AEC fact sheet, Feb 2026
$90m party cap, $11m third-party cap	AAP via ACM newspapers; The Daily Aus
“Major-party stitch-up” criticism	AAP / CityNews
ParlView archive since 1991; conditions of use	Parliament of Australia
Crown copyright 50 years	“Copyright expiration in Australia” (confirm with Australian Copyright Council fact sheet G023)
PM Transcripts licensed CC BY 4.0	pmtranscripts.pmc.gov.au/copyright

Well-established record (double-check wording): Murdoch’s 1985 US citizenship; The Australian backing Whitlam in 1972; the Dismissal on 11 Nov 1975 and Fraser’s landslide on 13 Dec 1975; the four leadership changes 2010–2018; Howard losing Bennelong in 2007; Dutton losing Dickson in 2025; compulsory voting from 1924; Ricky Muir’s 2013 election; 2016 Senate voting reform; the 2022 teal wins; Palmer as Member for Fairfax 2013–2016.

Before you publish: confirm exact ParlView dates (Packer 1991 hearing, Feb 2021 media inquiry, Feb 2025 reform debate) on ParlInfo; check whether any legal challenge to the 2026 donation caps has started; keep every claim about Turnbull’s 2018 downfall framed as his view, with News Corp’s denial.